T.B.C. : CDS-ENG-24-A Serial No. **589201**	**TEST BOOKLET** **[A]** SERIES	**Time Allowed : Two Hours** **Maximum Marks : 100**

UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

COMBINED DEFENCE SERVICES (CDS) EXAMINATION

TEST BOOKLET

GENERAL ENGLISH

ENTER ROLL NO. :

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET DOES NOT HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC. IF SO, GET IT REPLACED BY A COMPLETE TEST BOOKLET.

2. Please note that it is the candidate's responsibility to encode and fill in the **Roll Number** and **Test Booklet Series Code A, B, C or D** carefully and without any omission or discrepancy at the appropriate places in the OMR Answer Sheet. Any omission/discrepancy will render the Answer Sheet liable for rejection.

3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the Box provided above. **DO NOT write anything else on the Test Booklet.**

4. This Test Booklet contains **120 items (questions)**. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose **ONLY ONE** response for each item.

5. You have to mark all your responses **ONLY on the separate Answer Sheet provided**. See directions in the Answer Sheet.

6. All items carry equal marks.

7. Before you proceed to mark in the Answer Sheet the response to various items in the Test Booklet, you have to fill in some particulars in the Answer Sheet as per instructions sent to you with your Admission Certificate.

8. After you have completed the examination, you should hand over to the Invigilator only the Answer Sheet. You are permitted to take away with you the Test Booklet.

9. Sheets for rough work are appended in the Test Booklet at the end.

10. PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS :
THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.
(i) There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, **one-third (0.28 mark (one-third))** of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
(ii) If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
(iii) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.

DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO

SECTION : USAGE OF PAIRED WORDS

1. Presumptive and Presumptuous [CDS (II) 2026 Q1]

(a) Presumptive means something likely to be true, and Presump- tuous means to be disrespectfully bold
(b) Presumptive means to be dis- respectfully bold, and Presump- tuous means something likely to be true
(c) Presumptive means to exist, and Presumptuous means something very important
(d) Presumptive means something very important, and Presumptuous means to exist

2. Tempestuous and Temperamental [CDS (II) 2026 Q2]

(a) Tempestuous means unpredictable behaviour, and Temperamental means displaying violent behavi- our
(b) Tempestuous means displaying violent behaviour, and Tempera- mental means unpredictable behaviour
(c) Tempestuous means transitory, and Temperamental means deter- mined by temperature
(d) Tempestuous means determined by temperature, and Tempera- mental means transitory

3. Voyager and Voyeur [CDS (II) 2026 Q3]

(a) Voyager means a travel writer, and Voyeur means an emotionally vulnerable person
(b) Voyager means an emotionally vulnerable person, and Voyeur means a travel writer
(c) Voyager means a person who enjoys watching the private life of others, and Voyeur means a traveller
(d) Voyager means a traveller, and Voyeur means a person who enjoys watching the private life of others

4. Differ and Defer [CDS (II) 2026 Q4]

(a) Differ means to diffuse, and Defer means to be respectful
(b) Differ means to be respectful, and Defer means to diffuse
(c) Differ means to be different from something, and Defer means to delay action
(d) Differ means to delay action, and Defer means to be different from something

5. Elegy and Eulogy [CDS (II) 2026 Q5]

(a) Elegy means a moumful poem, and Eulogy means a tribute to the
(b) Elegy means a tribute to the dead, and Eulogy means a moumful
(c) Elegy means an inscription on a gravestone, and Eulogy means a contemptuous utterance
(d) Elegy means an allegation, and Eulogy means an inscription on the gravestone

6. Concord and Concourse [CDS (II) 2026 Q6]

(a) Concord means unity and harmony, and Concourse means the large open space in a building for people to gather
(b) Concord means convergence, and Concourse means to move jointly
(c) Concord means collaboration, and Concourse means goodwill
(d) Concord means to cohere, and Concourse means to unify diverse positions

7. Edify and Educe [CDS (II) 2026 Q7]

(a) Edify means to be elated, and Educe means to subtract
(b) Edify means to improve and uplift, and Educe means to extract information
(c) Edify means to enlighten, and Educe means to reduce
(d) Edify means to delight, and Educe means to be tolerant

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

8. Flaunt and Flinch [CDS (II) 2026 Q8]

(a) Flaunt means to be flamboyant, and Flinch means to be imper- tinent
(b) Flaunt means to strut about, and Flinch means to boast
(c) Flaunt means to display with flamboyance, and Flinch means to shy away
(d) Flaunt means to exhibit, and Flinch means to breach

9. Ingenious and Ingenuous [CDS (II) 2026 Q9]

(a) Ingenious means to be resourceful, and Ingenuous means to be rooted
(b) Ingenious means to be artless, and Ingenuous means to be inventive
(c) Ingenious means to be naturally talented, and Ingenuous means to be genuine
(d) Ingenious means to be creative, and Ingenuous means to be naively trusting

10. Nefarious and Nebulous [CDS (II) 2026 Q10]

(a) Nefarious means scandalous, and Nebulous means indistinct
(b) Nefarious means destitute, and Nebulous means vague
(c) Nefarious means wicked, and Nebulous means unpleasant
(d) Nefarious means fastidious, and Nebulous means exposed

SECTION : ANTONYMS

11. As a child she displayed a precocious talent for music. [CDS (II) 2026 Q11]

(a) mildly unobtrusive (b) unusually advanced (c) markedly reluctant (d) somewhat diffident

12. He spoke with a tremulous voice. [CDS (II) 2026 Q12]

(a) steady (b) quivering (c) sturdy (d) calm

13. These days there is a lot of gratuitous violence on television. [CDS (II) 2026 Q13]

(a) unjustified (b) gratifying (c) grating (d) unqualified

14. His remarks precipitated disaffection among the group. [CDS (II) 2026 Q14]

(a) insensitive (b) boastful (c) sequestering (d) provocative

15. Her career as a gymnast has been blighted by the decisions taken by her coach. [CDS (II) 2026 Q15]

(a) shortened (b) ruined (c) extended (d) accelerated

16. The office staff were left absolutely nonplussed by the unexpected question posed by the boss. [CDS (II) 2026 Q16]

(a) exacerbated (b) disaffected (c) perplexed (d) petrified

17. He had not completed the mandatory training for his promotion to the level of senior manager. [CDS (II) 2026 Q17]

(a) perfunctory (b) compulsory (c) recommendatory (d) introductory

18. One ought not to be dogmatic about one's beliefs. [CDS (II) 2026 Q18]

(a) ngld (b) amenable (c) deterministic (d) unassuming

19. Guests visiting the professor are inevitably treated to a scrumptious meal. [CDS (II) 2026 Q19]

(a) lavish (b) sustainable (c) delectable (d) abstemious

20. The menu for the birthday party comprised only sweet items, which took the gathered children by surprise. [CDS (II) 2026 Q20]

(a) salty (b) blanched (c) sugary (d) spicy

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

SECTION : WORD MEANING & VOCABULARY DEFINITIONS

21. Codex [CDS (II) 2026 Q21]

(a) An ancient manuscript in book form
(b) A member of a monastic community
(c) An algorithm for cracking codes
(d) An ancient time-measuring device

22. Ergonomics [CDS (II) 2026 Q22]

(a) The study of market relations
(b) The non-SI unit for energy
(c) The study of people's efficiency in their working environment
(d) The study of agricultural economics

23. Sobriquet [CDS (II) 2026 Q23]

(a) A thin broth or gruel
(b) An assumed name or nickname
(c) A broken piece of glass
(d) An image or likeness of something

24. Viticulture [CDS (II) 2026 Q24]

(a) The making of vinegar
(b) The activation of any fermentable liquid
(c) The process of making wine
(d) The cultivation of grapevines

25. Communiqué [CDS (II) 2026 Q25]

(a) An official order with retrospective effect
(b) An official order with prospective effect
(c) An official retraction of an order
(d) An official announcement or statement

26. Sub-judice [CDS (II) 2026 Q26]

(a) A matter under judicial consideration
(b) Not showing or allowing any doubt regarding the legality of a matter
(c) Legal authority over an important matter
(d) A view that is untenable in the eyes of law

27. Manifesto [CDS (II) 2026 Q27]

(a) A written, printed or typed copy of words that have been spoken
(b) A written statement describing the policies, goals, and positions of a person or group
(c) Written laws that are formally created by a government
(d) A written description of an organisation's functions and responsibilities

28. Tapestry [CDS (II) 2026 Q28]

(a) An engraved design on the surface of a metal plate
(b) An artwork using various discarded materials
(c) A hand-dyed painting on delicate fabrics
(d) A heavy decorative woven cloth hung on a wall

29. Connotation [CDS (II) 2026 Q29]

(a) The suggested idea or implication beyond the literal meaning
(b) Language that describes something as better or worse than it really is
(c) A main subject that is elaborated upon in a piece of writing
(d) A literal or primary dictionary meaning of a word

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

30. Alibi [CDS (II) 2026 Q30]

(a) A proven fact of having been elsewhere at the time of the commitment of a crime

(b) A witness in court who speaks in favour of the defendant

(c) Presenting a proxy to obviate legal punishment

(d) Proving to be someone other than the accused and escaping thereby

SECTION : ORDERING OF SENTENCES IN A PARAGRAPH (S1-S6)

31. S1: In a typical Indian village today, one is certain to find groups of women talking about finance. S6: In a society where women play significant but never-recognised roles, being a part of an SHG which gives them such financial power is indeed a matter of pride. P: Sitting there, they might proudly introduce themselves by saying that they are members of a self-help group (SHG). Q: They can be seen sitting under a tree, in an abandoned school building, or in the front yard of a village resident's home, holding thick notebooks. R: Alternatively, they might lend money at reasonable interest rates to members for starting small businesses. S: An SHG is usually a community group of 10-12 women from similar socio-economic background who pool their financial resources for taking up joint economic activities. [CDS (II) 2026 Q31]

(a) QPRS (b) RPSQ (c) RQSP (d) QSPR

32. S1: For much of history, surnames, or last names, were not considered necessary. S6: These two pieces of medieval bureaucracy meant that virtually everyone had to settle on a definite and fixed surname. P: The other was the enactment of the Statute of Additions in 1413, which required all legal documents to contain not just the person's given name, but also his occupation and place of abode. Q: One was the introduction of a poll tax in 1379, which led the government to collect the name of every person aged sixteen or over. R: But sometimes, the process was accelerated such as in England where two events gave a boost to the adoption of surnames. S: The business of acquiring surnames was a long one that evolved over centuries rather than sudden decree. [CDS (II) 2026 Q32]

(a) RSPQ (b) QPRS (c) SRQP (d) RQPS

SECTION : SENTENCE ORDERING (S1-S6)

33. : The first American settlers happened to live in the midst of perhaps the most exciting period in the history of the English language. Had the settlers gone a quarter of a century earlier, America might well have preserved those pre- vious forms, as it preserved many other archaisms. P • Similarly, thee and thou pronoun forms were also dying out. This was a time when 12,000 words were being added to the language. One such change which these first settlers had already adopted was to use the s form on verbs, saying has rather than hath, runs rather than runneth. S • It was also a time of considerable change in the structure of the language. [CDS (II) 2026 Q33]

(a) R PQS (b) Q SRP (c) SQPR (d) Q PRS -

34. Sl: In 1984, two small clay tablets of vaguely rectangular shape were found in Tell Brak, Syria, dating from the fourth millennium BCE. S6: All our history begins with these two modest tablets as they are among the oldest examples of writing we know. One of the animals may have been a goat, in which case, the other probably was a sheep. Lying there were these simple, unimpressive objects, each bearing a few discrete markings : a small indentation near the top and some sort of stick-drawn aninial in the centre. R : The indentation, on the other hand, represents, according to archaeologists, the number ten. S : These two tablets were seen by an expert the year before the Gulf War, in an unostentatious display case in the Archaeological Museum of Baghdad. [CDS (II) 2026 Q34]

(a) S Q PR (b) Q SPR (c) Q SRP (d) SQRP

35. Sl: For generations, the Balaraju pond remained the primary water source of Perakalapudi village in Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh. S6 : It was only after major restoration work was carried out to restore the pond's storage capacity that the community could return to its traditional livelihood. By the 2000s, decades of water mismanagement led to a rapid drop in the groundwater table as well. However, overexploitation caused the pond to shrink to half its original size and reduced its water storage capacity by 60 per cent. The pond, spread across 24 hec- tares, supported irigation, sus- tained the fishing community, met household needs and remained home to a wide variety of flora and fauna. S • As the pond disappeared, the households relied on groundwater to meet their daily needs. [CDS (II) 2026 Q35]

(a) Q RPS (b) Q PRS (c) R Q SP (d) R Q PS

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

36. Sl: While most people are com- fortable talking about colour, the concept of luminance — even though it is more fundamental — seems less familiar. S6: This is something the Impres- sionist artists were able to master and it gave a shimmering, lively quality to many of their paintings. P • For example, given two patches of grey, they can easily tell which is lighter. Q : As the artist and art teacher Josef Albers states, just as a musician should be able to distinguish between a higher tone and a lower tone, an artist should be able to distinguish between higher and lower light intensity between different colours. Artists, however, must learn to distinguish differences in lumi- nance, independent of colour. But given two patches of different colours, it is often difficult to make the same distinction. [CDS (II) 2026 Q36]

(a) PS R Q (b) PS QR (c) R Q SP (d) Q RSP

37. Sl: Wooden fumiture is durable and long-lasting, reducing the need for frequent replacement. S6: A still better and sustainable, though slow, way is to plant new trees to maintain the forest cover. Some of these negative impacts are deforestation and the loss of habitat for numerous species of Deforestation in turn disrupts water-cycles and accelerates the pace of climate change. However, its use causes several negative ecological impacts. One way of reducing the use of wood is to recycle it as much as possible. [CDS (II) 2026 Q37]

(a) R PQS (b) Q SPR (c) SQRP (d) PRS Q

38. Sl: Circadian rhythm is a term used to refer to the physical, mental and behavioural changes an organism experiences over a 24-hour cycle. S6: Maintaining a good circadian rhythm through appropriate expo- sure to natural light, consistent sleep schedules and times of eating, and adequate physical exercise during the day can allow an organism to live a healthy life. P : Prolonged disruption, moreover, can cause long-term damages such as metabolic diseases, cardio- vascular problems, and mental health issues. Light and dark (daytime and night-time) have the biggest influence on these circadian rhythms. Circadian rhythms are also affected by food intake, stress, physical activity, social environ- ment and temperature. When any one or more than one of these cause the circadian rhythm to be disrupted, it can lead to sleep problems, drowsiness and poor focus. [CDS (II) 2026 Q38]

(a) PRSQ (b) Q RSP (c) Q RPS (d) R Q PS

39. Sl: All the different parts of our eye help us to see. S6 : These electrical signals then travel through the optic nerve to the brain which in turn converts these signals into the images we see. P : The iris, which is the coloured part of the eye, controls how much light the pupil lets in. Q : Next, light passes through the lens, the clear inner part of the eye, which focuses this light on the retina. R • First, light passes through the comea, the clear front layer of the eye, and enters the eye through an opening called the pupil. S • When it hits the retina, special cells called photoreceptors convert the light into electrical signals. [CDS (II) 2026 Q39]

(a) RPSQ (b) R Q PS (c) RQSP (d) R PQS

40. Sl : Humans in colder climates first began wearing some form of sturdy foot covering at least 40,000 years ago. S6: Today, minimalistic barefoot shoes are becoming popular because they allow the wearer to feel the ground beneath their feet while still offering some protec- tion and support. P • Unfortunately, modern shoes have also had a negative impact on feet due to bad design such as a narrow toe box, difference in heel to toe drop, however slight, and stiff soles. Earlier skeletons had very robust little toes that could bend and grip surfaces. R These gradually evolved to become less substantial than the big toe because shoe-like coverings reduced the mechanical stress on them and made them weaker. The evidence for this comes from the study of changes in the structure of the toe bones of foot skeletons from that time. [CDS (II) 2026 Q40]

(a) , (b) and (c). Read each sentence to (b) Q SRP

(c) Q SPR (d) PS QR

SECTION : SPOTTING ERRORS

41. The teacher asked that who was absent in the class that day. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q41]

(a) The teacher asked that (b) who was absent (c) in the class that day. (d) No error

42. Neither of the two boys have done his homework. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q42]

(a) Neither of the two boys (b) have done his (c) homework. (d) No error

43. I recommended that he would reduce his expenditure. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q43]

(a) I recommended that (b) he would reduce (c) his expenditure. (d) No error

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

44. I am looking forward to meet you next month. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q44]

(a) I am looking forward (b) to meet you (c) next month. (d) No error

45. She said that she will help me in this matter. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q45]

(a) She said that (b) she will help me (c) in this matter. (d) No error

46. He insisted on knowing the reason of my absence. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q46]

(a) He insisted on knowing (b) the reason of (c) my absence. (d) No error

47. In your quotidian life you wouldn't find an elephant in the supermarket. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q47]

(a) In your quotidian life (b) you wouldn't find
(c) an elephant in the supermarket. (d) No error

48. I often dreamed of being famous in my prime. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q48]

(a) I often dreamed (b) of being famous (c) in my prime. (d) No error

49. These shoes designed for regular runners like yourself. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q49]

(a) These shoes designed (b) for regular runners (c) like yourself. (d) No error

50. Walk down our street any day you will see children playing. No error. [CDS (II) 2026 Q50]

(a) Walk down our street (b) any day you will (c) see children playing. (d) No error

SECTION : IDIOMS & PHRASES

51. To overplay one's hand [CDS (II) 2026 Q51]

(a) To spoil one's chance of success due to overconfidence (b) To play card games for too long
(c) To play exceedingly well with one (d) To be a strong arm-wrestler

52. Pass the buck [CDS (II) 2026 Q52]

(a) To treat someone badly (b) To deflect blame
(c) To refuse money (d) To accept an unpleasant result

53. Over one's head [CDS (II) 2026 Q53]

(a) Protective covering worn as a hat (b) Bypassing authority surreptitiously
(c) Appreciably taller than one (d) Beyond one's ability to understand

54. Have a finger in every pie [CDS (II) 2026 Q54]

(a) To be familiar with the most recent developments
(b) To gorge on food
(c) To be able to do something very well
(d) TO be involved in different acti- vities Choose the most appropriate meaning and accordingly.

55. To go out on a limb [CDS (II) 2026 Q55]

(a) Adopt a convenient position that aligns with the popular view (b) Adopt a convenient position that goes against the popular view
(c) Adopt a daring position that goes against the popular view (d) Adopt a daring position that aligns with the popular view

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

56. Live on your nerves [CDS (II) 2026 Q56]

(a) To be continually anxious (b) To live life to the fullest (c) To live without fear (d) To be steely nerved

57. Lilly-livered [CDS (II) 2026 Q57]

(a) Cowardly (b) Weak (c) Inebriated (d) Triumphant

58. To spill the beans [CDS (II) 2026 Q58]

(a) To be bursting with energy and health • (b) To let a secret slip out
(c) To be laidback and easy-going (d) To let food go waste

59. To make one's peace [CDS (II) 2026 Q59]

(a) To experience serenity (b) To avoid violence at any cost
(c) To put an end to a quarrel (d) To keep silent amidst adversity

60. Fall by the wayside [CDS (II) 2026 Q60]

(a) Fail to continue or drop out of an activity (b) To walk on the side of the road
(c) To lose one's way during a journey (d) To meet an accident on the road

SECTION : SYNONYMS

61. Her experience is requisite for the job. [CDS (II) 2026 Q61]

(a) essential (b) obligatory (c) vital (d) optional

62. They were given rudimentary training for the job. [CDS (II) 2026 Q62]

(a) fundamental (b) advanced (c) basic (d) elementary

63. She sat there looking morose. [CDS (II) 2026 Q63]

(a) To trip on the footpath (b) To lose one's sense of direction
(c) To weaken moral values (d) To drop out of a pursuit consists of a sentence with

64. If you listen carefully you'll discover that the soundtrack is fuzzy in places. [CDS (II) 2026 Q64]

(a) noisy (b) distorted (c) clear (d) vague

65. The shopkeeper is known to charge exorbitant rates for the articles in his [CDS (II) 2026 Q65]

(a) high (b) affordable (c) outrageous (d) ridiculous

66. If you ponder the matter you are likely to arrive at the appropriate conclusion. [CDS (II) 2026 Q66]

(a) mull (b) ignore (c) defer (d) rethink

67. The diagnosis based on radiological evidence determined the condition to be mortiferous. [CDS (II) 2026 Q67]

(a) exacerbating (b) degenerative (c) benign (d) lethal

68. The party president chose to placate his critics within the party. [CDS (II) 2026 Q68]

(a) prime (b) persuade (c) pacify (d) provoke

69. The magician was able to mesmerise the audience with his magic tricks. [CDS (II) 2026 Q69]

(a) distract (b) captivate (c) entertain (d) confuse

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

70. She led a precarious life as a theatre artist. [CDS (II) 2026 Q70]

(a) peaceful (b) insecure (c) luxurious (d) monotonous

SECTION : FILL IN THE BLANKS

71. Switzerland lies France, Germany, Austria and Italy. [CDS (II) 2026 Q71]

(a) insecure
(b) precious
(c) precipitous
(d) stable in this section has a blank space with four to fill in the blank and indicate your response

72. May I pay credit card ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q72]

(a) by (b) with (c) in (d) on

73. The information is available the Internet. [CDS (II) 2026 Q73]

(a) from (b) with (c) in (d) on

74. Didn't you borrow books of mine ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q74]

(a) some (b) any (c) few (d) many

75. If you have any leftover milk, could you spare me [CDS (II) 2026 Q75]

(a) little (b) a little (c) an little (d) any

76. He sat her all night. [CDS (II) 2026 Q76]

(a) aside (b) beside (c) besides (d) asides

77. Talk me your plans. [CDS (II) 2026 Q77]

(a) Lesser (b) Fewer (c) Few (d) Less

78. The officer was commended for his _____ devotion to duty. [CDS (II) 2026 Q78]

(a) unflinching (b) faltering (c) casual (d) intermittent

79. This beautiful historical building shall soon be restored to its state. [CDS (II) 2026 Q79]

(a) normal (b) pristine (c) degenerate (d) dilapidated

80. I don't like being stared [CDS (II) 2026 Q80]

(a) to (b) at (c) on (d) about

SECTION : SIMILAR SOUNDING WORDS

81. Weather, Whether, Whither I. Weather permitting, we'll have the gathering outside. 2. Whether conditions are likely to improve by Thursday. 3. They didn't know whither they should go. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q81]

(a) 2 and 3 only (b) I only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

82. Quiet, Quite, Quit 1. He plays quiet well. 2. They had a wedding. 3. He has decided to quit as the manager of the team. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q82]

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

83. Way, Weigh, Whey 1. I'm not happy with this of working. 2. How much does it weigh ? 3• is the thin liquid that separates from the solid parts when milk is curdled. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q83]

(a) 2 and 3 only (b) 2 only (c) I and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

84. Weave, Wave, Waive 1. She loves to wave stories. 2. Unfortunately, he had to waive his rights. 3. A huge weave broke on the shore. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q84]

(a) I and 3 only (b) 2 only (c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

85. Peak, Peek, Pique 1. Trafic reaches its peak between 8 and 9 in the moming. 2. She at the audience from behind the curtain. 3. When he realised nobody was listening to him, he left in a fit of pique. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q85]

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) I only (c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

86. Sent, Scent, Cent 1. A one minute phone call to the UK costs one sent. 2. The air was filled with the scent of wild flowers. 3. The dogs following him must have lost his cent. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q86]

(a) I and 2 only (b) 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

87. Aisle, Ale, Isle 1. I always prefer the isle seat in an aeroplane. 2. He always began his day with a glass of ginger g!g. 3. While on a picnic we discovered a small aisle in the middle of a lake. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q87]

(a) 2 and 3 only (b) 2 only (c) I and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

88. Rein, Reign, Arraign I. Queen Elizabeth 11 had a long rein as a British monarch. 2. One needs to in their impulses at times. 3. He was arraigned before the judge yesterday. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q88]

(a) 2 and 3 only (b) 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

SECTION : PAIRED SENTENCES

89. Ascend, Ascent, Assent 1. She made the ascend to the top of the mountains seem effortless. 2. The Prince waited a long time to ascent the throne. 3. She gave her tacit assent to the transfer of power. In which of the sentences given above have the underlined words been used correctly ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q89]

(a) I and 3 only (b) 2 only (c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

SECTION : SIMILAR SOUNDING WORDS

90. Brawl, Bawl, Bowl 1. The drunken brawl outside the tavern disturbed the entire neighborhood. 2. The hungry infant began to bawl loudly for milk. 3. He managed to bowl out the star batsman in the final over. [CDS (II) 2026 Q90]

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

SECTION : PAIRED SENTENCES

91. Sl. Many students failed in the examination. S2. However, those who attended extra classes did not fail. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q91]

(a) 2 only

(b) 1 and 2 only

(c) I only

(d) 1, 2 and 3 of sentences (Sl, S2) is given. Select the most of the second sentence to the first from among your response

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

92. Sl. The medicine was supposed to reduce his fever. S2. Even after taking it, his tempera- ture continued to rise. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q92]

(a) negates the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first

93. Sl. Mohan enjoys classical music. S2. Sohan likes popular musical genres. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q93]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first

94. Sl. Global warming is accelerating with each passing year. S2. Recent studies indicate that temperatures are rising across continents. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q94]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts the first (c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first

95. Sl. Sarah recently contended that she has never visited Paris. S2. Someone shared a photograph that shows Sarah standing underneath the Eiffel Tower. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q95]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first

96. Sl. The Indian team won the cham- pionship. S2. They were struggling in the preliminary rounds. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q96]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first

97. Geeta is an excellent public speaker. S2. She received a standing ovation after her speech. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q97]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) affrms the first (d) qualifies the first

98. The city is known for its modem architecture. S2. The neighbouring villages main- tain their traditional buildings. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q98]

(a) affirms the first (b) contrasts with the first (c) confirms the first (d) quantifies the first

SECTION : MATCH LIST I & II

99. Sl. The train is usually on time. S2. The train was delayed by an hour today. The second sentence : [CDS (II) 2026 Q99]

(a) qualifies the first (b) contradicts the first (c) contrasts with the first (d) confirms the first

SECTION : PAIRED SENTENCES

100. S1. This vaccine is highly effective in preventing severe infection. S2. Clinical trials have demonstrated a ninety percent reduction in hospitalisations. [CDS (II) 2026 Q100]

(a) confirms the first (b) contradicts the first (c) contrasts with the first (d) is unrelated to the first

SECTION : MATCH LIST I & II

101. List 1 List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Discreet I. Decaying B. Discrete 2. Tactful C. Desecrate 3. Defile D. Decrepit 4. Separate A B C D [CDS (II) 2026 Q101]

(a) contradicts the first (b) contrasts with the first
(c) confirms the first (d) qualifies the first select the answer using the code given below

102. List I List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Inflation I. Expansion B. Indentation 2. Declension C. Infiltration 3. Permeation D. Inflection 4. Depression Code : A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q102]

(a) 4 2 3 1 (b) 4 3 2 1 (c) 1 3 2 4 (d) 1 4 3 2 -

— SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK —

103. List 1 List 11 (Word/Term) (Meaning) A. Polyglot 1. Having more than one B. Polymorphous meaning C. Polysemy 2. A person of great and D. Polymath varied leaming 3. A person knowing more than one language 4. Having many different forms Code : A B c D [CDS (II) 2026 Q103]

(a) 3 2 4 (b) 3 4 2 1 (c) 3 4 1 2 (d) 4 3 1 2

104. List 1 List 11 (Word/Term) (Meaning) A. Philatelist l. A person who studies B. Philanthropist language C. Philologist 2. A person who does not value D. Philistine art or culture 3. A person who collects stamps 4. A person who helps the needy A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q104]

(a) 3 2 1 4 (b) 3 4 1 2 (c) 3 4 2 1 (d) 4 3 1 2

105. List 1 List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Tabernacle I. Biased B. Tenuous 2. Place of worship C. Tempestuous 3. Stormy D. Tendentious 4. Flimsy A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q105]

(a) 2 4 3 1 (b) 4 3 2 1 (c) 1 3 2 4 (d) 4 3 1 2

106. List 1 List 11 (Word/Term) (Meaning) A. Sacred I. Oblation B. Desecration 2. Consecrated C. Sacrosanct 3. Defilement D. Sacrifice 4. Inviolable A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q106]

(a) 3 4 1 2 (b) 2 3 4 1 (c) 2 4 1 3 (d) 3 1 4 2

107. List I List 11 (Word/Term) (Meaning) A. Triumph I. Feeling great pride post B. Triumphant victory C. Triumphal 2. Act of D. Triumphalism celebrating a great success or victory 3. A show of smug superiority 4. A notable success A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q107]

(a) 4 1 2 3 (b) 2 3 4 1 (c) 2 4 1 3 (d) 3 1 4 2

108. List 1 List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Revel 1. Unrestrained merriment B. Revelry C. Reveal 2. To make merry 3. Boisterous D. Reveller individual making merry 4. Disclose Code : A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q108]

(a) 1 4 2 3 (b) 4 3 2 1 (c) 2 4 3 (d) 3 4 1 2

109. List I List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Transmit 1. To happen or occur B. Transmute 2. To continue for C. Transpire only a short time D. Transient 3. TO change into something different 4. To send an electronic signal Code : A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q109]

(a) 3 4 2 1 (b) 4 2 3 1 (c) 2 4 1 3 (d) 4 3 1 2

110. List 1 List 11 (Word/ Term) (Meaning) A. Emanated 1. Liberated B. Emancipated 2. Starved C. Empathised 3. Ongmated D. Emaciated 4. Commiserated Code : A B c [CDS (II) 2026 Q110]

(a) 3 4 2 1 (b) 4 2 1 3 (c) 3 1 4 2 (d) 4 3 1 2

SECTION : READING COMPREHENSION

111. In this passage, "women's suffrage" refers to : [CDS (II) 2026 Q111]

(a) Women's suffering
(b) Women's inability to read
(c) Women's right to vote in political elections
(d) Women's anger at political rallies

112. In this passage, "grassroots" refers to : [CDS (II) 2026 Q112]

(a) The common people at a local level
(b) The common problems faced by people
(c) The root cause of poverty
(d) The gentry in the cities

113. Which of the following is the correct noun form of "subversive" ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q113]

(a) Subvert (b) Subverting (c) Subversion (d) Subvention

114. In this passage, "canonical literature" refers to : [CDS (II) 2026 Q114]

(a) War literature
(b) Nonsensical literature
(c) Influential and significant litera-
(d) Pretentious and bombastic litera-

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115. According to the passage, the primary challenge faced by the local fishing community was : [CDS (II) 2026 Q115]

(a) the rapid depletion of groundwater and pond shrinkage
(b) lack of government subsidies
(c) competition from modern trawlers
(d) seasonal migration of bird species

116. This passage traces the history of ... [CDS (II) 2026 Q116]

(a) pliant
(b) hesitant
(c) persistent
(d) defiant the questions given below : New World in 1492. Six years later, Vasco da next two centuries the Spaniards and the but to many parts of Asia as well, a number and central America, in expectation of their plants had been developed to a high degree by Of these, the potato (Solanum tuberosum) is slopes on the high plateau of Bolivia-Peru in BC. Europeans first saw potatoes in South brought the first potatoes to Europe. Though incorrectly called batata (the name for the sweet in English in 1597, and this name stuck. An and beans were in high repute as foods in the first to introduce the culture of potatoes, Cape of Good Hope. From there the British vegetable useful at the table, as well as several especially various kinds of pot herbs.

117. According to this passage, how long ago was the potato domesticated in South America ? [CDS (II) 2026 Q117]

(a) Two thousand years ago
(b) Two to five thousand years ago
(c) Four to seven thousand years ago
(d) Ten thousand years ago -

118. In this passage the word "culture" refers to [CDS (II) 2026 Q118]

(a) The arts, music, literature and other intellectual achievements
(b) All the knowledge and values shared by a society
(c) The practices of the Maya and Inca civilisations
(d) Certain techniques of raising plants for propagation

119. Which form of the word "settlement" can be used both as a verb and as an adjective ? - [CDS (II) 2026 Q119]

(a) Settled (b) Settling (c) Settler (d) Settle

120. The word "terraced" has been formed by changing [CDS (II) 2026 Q120]

(a) A noun to a verb (b) A verb to a noun (c) An adjective to a noun (d) A noun to an adjective

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